

PREMISE DELTA v0.2 (THE COMFORT BLANKET): DISPOSITION · 2026-09-07 (Fable and GPT in)

Two independent adversaries were asked to break four-keys-premise-delta-comfort-blanket-v0.2-2026-09-07.md on the same six fronts. Fable's result is filed verbatim in ...-attack-fable-2026-09-07.md; GPT's goes beside it when Stephen runs it. Author positions are hypotheses; this table is the check. Stephen rules.

Fable's findings, front by front, with my concurrence

Front	Fable	Concur?	Note
1 Violet's engine	Fatal	Yes.	The decisive point: her true letter still says "someone with my spare key has been in my house; you four know where the spare lives, which is why it's you reading this", and it is conditional on her death. That is v8.1's fear of the four with the "I think" hedge removed, and the hedge was doing three jobs (why she posts a key to the killer; why Brad forges rather than leaves an exonerating letter; the chapter 7 turn). Also decisive on the panel: a gilded piece is days of work and consumes leaf and board; the best judge of a hand on the coast checks her stock and knows in a minute she did not make it. "I don't know whether I made it" is credible about a tin lid, not about that object.
2 The kept letter	Serious for Brad, fatal for the close	Yes.	A documentary criminal does not keep the one page that proves the swap; and on arrest the room is searched by police and the letter is evidence in a murder, never shown to a podcaster before trial. "Ally reads it in the close" has no lawful route.
3 The Monday night	Fatal	Yes.	Three questions v8.1 does not have: "if she knew which of us, why did she post the killer a key?" (v8.1's "I don't know which" answers it); Brad's motive to manufacture a murder accusation when the true letter, under v0.2, reads as a frightened woman's; and the board's whereabouts, which v8.1 already answers (see the grazes below) but v0.2's bare note sharpens.
4 The first minute	Serious	Yes.	"The note didn't say why" is an announced withholding; and my sketch's "had killed her" is a tense error a listener catches (mine).
5 Chapter 7	Serious	Yes.	A list, not a turn. And one item is unsupportable as phrased (see graze 2).
6 The five facts	Two fatal, two serious	Yes.	Ruby the nurse, asked about early dementia in the car, discounts the forgery on night one. Liam the boatyard man reads a four-key pack on night one. The two signwriters say "your apprentice" on Day minus 40 (see graze 1).

Verdict, Fable: REJECT, high confidence. I concur, independently of GPT. The engine v0.2 claims (shame instead of fear) is not what its own letter says, and the facts it admits to buy the framing each arm a competent character to end the episode in its first week.

Three grazes on the RULED premise (v8.1 + amendments v1.5 to v1.7) that this attack surfaced, to be checked regardless of the v0.2 ruling

1. **The two signwriters and "your apprentice."** On 2026-09-05 the panel became Violet's own alphabet, done better than she can. Under v8.1 she still shows it to two other signwriters (spine A1, Day

minus 70 to minus 40) asking whose hand it is. A professional shown Violet Moore's alphabet by Violet Moore says "your boy, surely". Violet's letter already answers it for herself ("I know it's not Brad's work. I taught him everything he knows and I'm not that good a teacher"), so it does not break Day minus 40. But it changes what those two witnesses tell Ally in chapter 6 and chapter 9: not "we could not place the hand" but "it was her alphabet; we said her pupil". That points at a presumed-dead man three chapters early.

Action: sweep the two signwriters under the alphabet ruling before chapter 6 is briefed; either they never saw it as her alphabet (a hand derived from hers, not hers), or the chapter 6 beat is re-timed. This is the one real cost of Saturday's alphabet ruling and it needs Stephen's eye.

2. **"Nobody alive ever saw Brad write" (spine R3a, chapter 7).** Fable: his lettering is on shopfronts across the city, and he sat at Ruby's table for weeks working a letter with a pen. The spine's claim is about cursive handwriting, not brush lettering, but the table is a real exposure. **Action: pin in the spine that Brad never wrote at the table (Ruby kept the notes; Brad read aloud), so R3a holds in the room.** One line.
3. **The board's whereabouts between Day 0 and Day 14.** Fable asks who would have seen it in the hall after her death. v8.1 already answers: Brad took it off its hook at 22:20 on Day 0; Liam found her on Day 1 and the scene photographs show the empty hook and a pale rectangle (R16); the survivors' later account is that she took it down herself to hide it, and nobody can date the hook because none of the four had been in the house since before Day minus 19 (rows 5b, 31). **No change; noted as verified against the current spine.**

Recommendation

Premise v8.1 stands, with one sentence of trust in the key letter (Stephen's ruling of 2026-09-07, question 3), as before this delta. The comfort-blanket idea goes to the idea bank with two salvageable pieces: Violet doubting herself is a shade the v8.1 letter already carries in "I might be wrong. I've been wrong about people before", and could be deepened by one clause without changing what she believes; and the same-night opening, the PO box and Brad's own locker, already ruled into v1.7, came out of this exploration.

GPT's column, added 2026-09-08

GPT's result (...-attack-chatgpt-2026-09-07.md) is REJECT, high confidence, independently of Fable and on the same decisive point. Front by front: 1 fatal (the shame does not scale: she carries the panel round a small city but will not speak to a nurse who loves her; excluding Brad is "naked plot preservation"); 2 fatal (a documentary criminal keeps the one page that proves the swap, in a room the landlady enters); 3 fatal, and named as the verdict's driver ("if she knew which of us, why give that person a key and send the other three to meet them at a locker without police": the two letters cannot come from one rational author); 4 serious ("the note didn't say why" is a delay, not a hook; names before stakes); 5 fatal (a list, not a turn: five debatable observations that attack different propositions); 6 fatal (each of the five facts arms an early ender: Brad burning the letter Monday morning, Ruby not accepting a subject change, Day 2 record-reading being improper, any recipient visiting the locker first, town gossip reaching the other three as easily as Brad).

Two adversaries, two rejects, one shared decisive finding. **vo.2 is dead and is filed as such.** What survives it is recorded in the recommendation above and in the vo.3 work: Stephen's 2026-09-08 move that the forgery need not say "I know" at all, which removes the Monday-night contradiction both adversaries found decisive, is the basis of vo.3, the trusting forgery.